Magic rule – Spell slots · SRD 5.2.1

A **spell slot** is the energy needed to cast a level 1 or higher spell. You spend one of a level **equal to or higher** than the spell. **Cantrips** cost none. Slots return after a **Long Rest**.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. A slot of **level ≥ spell** is needed.
2. A higher slot = spell **at a higher level**.
3. **One slot** per turn to cast a spell.
4. Recovery: **Long Rest** (Warlock: Short Rest).

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 clarifies you may expend only **one spell slot per turn** to cast a spell.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say whether a spell can be cast at a lower level. Fix: no, the slot's level must be at least the spell's.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can ask which slot is used before describing the effect.

Step 1 – Choose the spell:

Note its level.

Step 2 – Choose the slot:

Equal or higher level.

Step 3 – Spend:

The slot is consumed.

Step 4 – Higher level:

The spell takes that level (damage, duration, targets).

Step 5 – Recover:

After a **Long Rest**, all your slots return.

Example: Ysolde casts Fireball (level 3) with a level 4 slot: 9d6 damage instead of 8d6.

SPELL SLOTS (5E, 2024 RULES) – SLOTS BY LEVEL (FULL CASTER)

Lvl	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1	2	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
2	3	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
3	4	2	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
4	4	3	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
5	4	3	2	–	–	–	–	–	–
6	4	3	3	–	–	–	–	–	–
7	4	3	3	1	–	–	–	–	–
8	4	3	3	2	–	–	–	–	–
9	4	3	3	3	1	–	–	–	–
10	4	3	3	3	2	–	–	–	–
11	4	3	3	3	2	1	–	–	–
13	4	3	3	3	2	1	1	–	–
15	4	3	3	3	2	1	1	1	–
17	4	3	3	3	2	1	1	1	1
18	4	3	3	3	3	1	1	1	1
19	4	3	3	3	3	2	1	1	1
20	4	3	3	3	3	2	2	1	1

⚠ Common questions:

What is a slot?

The energy a spell needs.

Do cantrips cost one?

No.

Can I cast higher?

Yes, with a higher slot.

How many per turn?

One slot spent.

When do they return?

On a Long Rest.

And the Warlock?

On a Short Rest.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Lower slot

Can I cast lower with a penalty? **Option**: no.

Two spells in a turn

Action and bonus action with 2 slots? **Option**: one slot spell per turn.

Partial recovery

Does a Short Rest return a slot? **Option**: no, unless a feature does.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Cantrips

They don't consume a slot.

Slot level

It sets the casting level.

Warlock

Regains slots on a Short Rest.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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